

AN INNOVATIVE EXPERIENCE

SPJIMR HAS ALWAYS THOUGHT OUT OF THE BOX, WITH A FOCUS ON RESEARCH AND SOCIAL ENGAGEMENT. THAT UNIQUENESS REMAINS

BY KRISHNA GOPALAN

THERE IS A WIDE grin on Varun Nagaraj's face. "I complete three years as the dean," he says. Helming SPJIMR is no easy task and Nagaraj brings to the table experience not only from the world of academia but from the professional world of Silicon Valley. It was especially relevant for India, which has a different terrain for everything and education is no exception.

Housed in a compact campus in Andheri, a suburb in western Mumbai, the institute is a beehive of activity as the summer placement process for the new batch gets underway.

The students came aboard just three months ago but this is a big

deal as it sets the base for making many career decisions. For many years, the institute was known for its autumn placement or an internship about halfway into the second year. "It was difficult for many companies to make that adjustment just for us," explains Nagaraj. That move appears to have paid off, with more companies showing interest to pick the finest minds. This is for the flagship two-year programme, which has a long list of achievers.

The campus also boasts of robust infrastructure. The classrooms are set in a modern environment that includes video conferencing platforms like Zoom, Cisco, Webex, and Google Meet—

all used for online classes, hybrid meetings, and webinars.

Recruiters come from sectors as varied as consulting, FMCG, financial services, information technology, to name a few, apart from international ones. While a lot has been taking place at the institute, Nagaraj outlines two areas where significant progress has been made—research and social engagement.

Research is about innovation and mapping the domain to a faculty's research interests. It also includes Management Practice Insights, a collection of journal articles picked from any part of the world and translated (made more relevant) for managers and business leaders worldwide. This comes out twice a year and addresses issues such as how companies should rotate their auditors or use virtual reality as a game changer in accurately predicting sales for new product launches. "It helps in influencing managerial practice and builds the SPJIMR brand," Nagaraj says. A lot of attention is put not just on one's work but also on what impact it has on society.

Apart from that, there are specific areas where the institute has been working to go beyond the classroom. Within this, SPJIMR has closely worked with the underprivileged sections of society. The institute works with nearly 600 NGOs and the objective is to churn out 100 managers with a focus on the development sector. Nagaraj calls this exercise "capability building in the NGO sector."

This is a blended 12-month modular programme, which has six contact periods of two weeks each. The first, third, and last contacts are in-person and of a residential nature on campus, while the other

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**S. P. JAIN INSTITUTE
OF MANAGEMENT & RESEARCH**

Overall score

861.3

**Placements
in 2024**

🔴 All students placed, with a median salary of ₹31.50 lakh per annum

**Campus
experience**

🔴 Situated in a 45-acre oasis, features state-of-the-art classrooms and a distinctive library
🔴 Campus provides easy access to Mumbai's diverse cultural, entertainment, and shopping destinations

**New initiatives
(digital/entrepreneurship)**

🔴 International Technology and Societal Impact Conference (TaSIC) scheduled for February 2025
🔴 Focus on research through in-house journal called 'Management Practices Insights'